Zachary Shankman

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Skill Summary

Motivated Computer Game Design major with strong analytical skills and a passion for game system and mechanic design. Adept C# and Java programmer with experience in C++, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Python, and basic SQL. 6+ years of experience working in Unity, and proficiency in many different programs such as Unreal, Photoshop, 3dsMax, Substance Painter, FLStudio, DaVinci Resolve, and various source control services.

Work Experience

Software Development Intern
Charm City Filmmakers, LLC | Baltimore, MD

June 2026 to Present

Created a custom scheduling app for use by Charm City Filmmakers LLC, completely from scratch, in Unity. Features currently implemented: Relational database with user registration/authentication using Supabase, email system using Resend to notify users/management of reservations, full UI and calendar functionality in Unity with C#

Various Customer Service Positions
Lowe's, Walgreens, Staples | Leesburg, VA

August 2017 to June 2022

Education

Computer Game Design (Bachelor of Fine Arts)
George Mason University | Fairfax, VA

August 2023 to December 2026

Gained experience in every facet of game development with a primary focus on programming, especially in C#. Worked in teams of over 30 on large scale games, utilizing common industry practices such as Git source control and Agile/Scrum. Expected graduation in December 2026 with a BFA in Computer Game Design.

Noteworthy Courses:

- GAME 490 - Worked as the lead programmer in this year long, small group course where students complete the entire process of game development throughout the year such as writing pitch documents, A GDD, production plans, vertical slices, beta testing, and eventually a fully functional game.
- GAME 410 - Course emulates a true game development studio with a group of approximately 30 students, separated into design, programming, art, and sound teams. Worked as a programmer, writing a significant portion of the game's code and doing the large majority of the debugging.
- GAME 310 - Learned how to build complex lighting systems, blueprints, and camera systems in Unreal Engine, with a strong focus on level design.
- CS 110/112 - Learned the fundamentals of computer science and programming, also gaining experience in Java and Python.
- AVT 217 - Learned how to program in HTML and CSS along with basic JavaScript in order to build a website from scratch.

General Studies (2 Semesters)
Blue Ridge Community College | Harrisonburg, VA

August 2022 to May 2023

Computer Science (3 Semesters)
George Mason University | Fairfax, VA

August 2019 to December 2020

High School Diploma
Heritage High School | Leesburg, VA

August 2015 to June 2019